

modal licks (quotes) with recurring rhythms

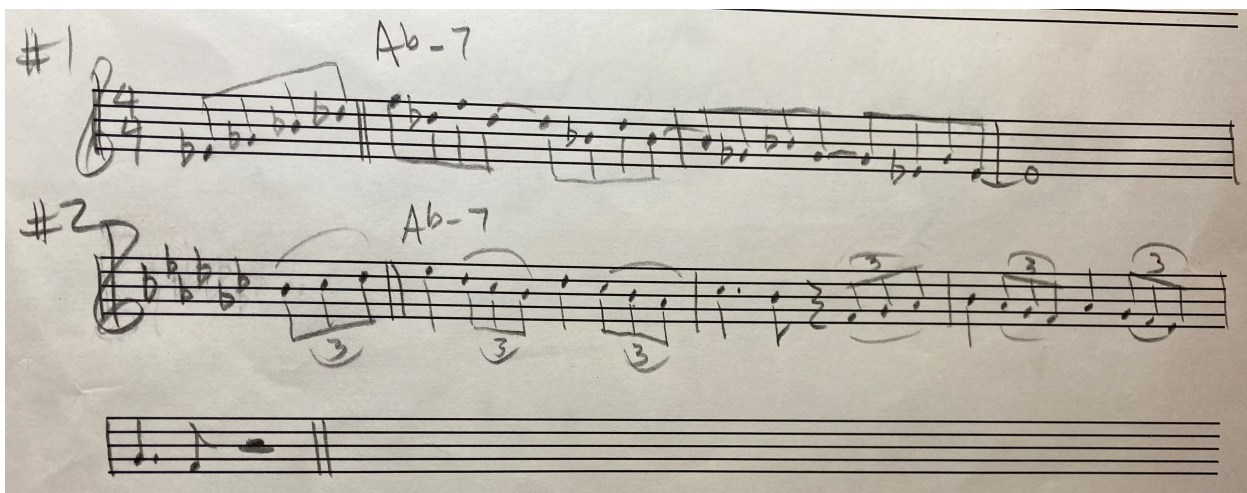
On the recent tunes Jeannine and Voyage in the Blue community with modal sections and the discussions of grande arpeggios, recurring rhythms etc. I thought I'd write out a couple of licks that have been personal earworms recently. Consider applying these to medium and up tempo tunes.

I'm not sure exactly what tune the first lick is from but let's call it a "Cedar Walton lick" for now because I believe he played this or wrote it into one of his tunes. You can start it from any note in the grande arpeggio. I chose the highest note to be the 6th (13th) because I like that sound. The original melody may start on a different note.

Lick #2 is Wayne Shorter's intro to Witch Hunt. I like the sound of starting this on a Bb note over the intended

Ab-7 on Jeannine. Also start it on an Ab note and keep with this scale pattern which actually sounds closer to Wayne's melody over the first couple of bars. Note that in bar 2 beat 4 I start the line a 4th down on the note F and not on the Gb like Wayne did (if you transpose into this key.) The idea is to use the rhythm and put your own notes to it to fit whatever chord progression you are playing on.

My main point is to borrow these rhythms and melodic contours from great compositions like these. They will add authenticity and a rhythmic and melodic



spark to your improvising.